

Syllabus Extension: Qualitative Research Proposal Detail Guidance

You will compose a Qualitative Research Proposal paper focusing on a relevant field and applied problem. The project emphasizes application of the qualitative research concepts, demonstrating understanding of the process and constructing a rigorous research proposal.

These detailed guidelines draw from textbook methods, planned class discussions, and the course syllabus to provide you with a clear roadmap for success. Use them not only to meet course requirements but to build your confidence in developing strong research proposals.

I'm here to support your learning outcomes and success on this assignment and the course.

The overall paper structure and section-by-section guidance are described below.

Paper Structure

1. Title Page (1 page): Title of the Research Proposal, Student name, DBA Cohort Number, Date
2. Introduction (3-4 pages)
 - Focus and Research Problem
 - Research Purpose
 - Research Question
 - Interpretive Framework and Assumptions
 - Terminology Definitions
3. Literature Review (3-4 pages)
4. Methodology (3-4 pages)
5. Expected Contributions (1 page)
6. Proposed Timeline (1 page)
7. References: List complete AP citation style references for all works cited in your proposal

Use double spaced, and APA formatting.

Page guidance is approximate (minimum required).

Proofread and edit your writing.

Submit draft iterations and final paper through the assignment section of the Canvas course.

INTRODUCTION SECTION

We will cover these topics during Weeks 2 through 4 to support your learning and the iterative development of your proposal.

This section of the proposal introduces and focuses the study interrelating the study problem, purpose, and research questions demonstrating methodological congruence.

The introduction section has the following sub-sections:

- Focus and Research Problem
- Research Purpose
- Research Question
- Interpretive Framework and Assumptions
- Terminology Definitions

The description of each sub-section and rubric guidance are provided below. Use the rubric guidance to apply learning and iterate.

Focus and Research Problem	The extent to which the introduction advances the topic and uses a compelling hook that engages the reader. Write a few beginning sentences or a paragraph to create reader interest. A good first sentence called a “narrative hook” creates reader interest through stating timely topics, advancing a key controversy, using numbers, or citing a leading study. Also, clearly state the topic being addressed in the study. ○ No narrative hook is present, or the introduction fails to engage the reader. ○ A basic narrative hook is provided but lacks strong engagement. ○ The narrative hook is clear, relevant, and effectively draws the reader into the topic.
	The extent to which the research problem is clearly introduced communicating a justification for the study’s need. Frame the research problem as an argument addressing the study’s importance or “why my study topic matters.” A research problem can come from real-life issues or from a gap in the literature, or both. A qualitative study may lead to new insights, fill a void in existing literature, or establish a new line of thinking. ○ Research problem is unclear or not stated, and the need for the study is not established. ○ Research problem is stated but lacks clear justification and need for the study. ○ Research problem is clearly stated, with strong justification of the need for the study.
	The extent to which relevant scholarly literature is summarized to provide insight into the research problem. Summarize recent evidence relevant to the research problem. Has anyone studied my research problem or a closely related topic? Use literature to provide the rationale for the problem and position one’s study within the ongoing literature about the topic. Do not provide detail (you will do that in the Literature Review section.) Summarize the general literature—the groups of literature that have addressed the problem or closest to the topic. ○ No literature (or industry facts) is summarized to provide evidence of the problem. ○ The connection to the literature referenced to the research problem is unclear. ○ Relevant literature is effectively summarized, providing strong insight into the research problem.
	The extent to which gaps or deficiencies in the current literature are clearly identified and explained. Summarize gaps in context of understanding the problem. What gaps remain? And how can my chosen qualitative approach contribute to filling those gaps?”. For example, for a Case Study, you can discuss how the study of case or cases can help inform the issue or concern. For a grounded theory study, authors state that we need a theory that explains a process because existing theories are inadequate for the context under study. ○ No evidence gaps are identified, or the relevance of the gap is unclear. ○ Some gaps in evidence are identified, but they are not clearly tied to the study’s rationale. ○ Clear gaps in the literature are identified and linked to the need for the research study.
	The extent to which the proposal argues the importance of the study for specific audience(s). Point out, for different audiences, the ways they will benefit from the study. For example, for a Case Study, the researcher might discuss how the in-depth descriptions will benefit practitioners understanding of a unique context. For grounded theory, describe the audience who would care about the theoretical explanation. ○ The study’s importance is unclear or not stated, and the audience is not stated. ○ The study’s importance and audience(s) are stated but lack connection to the study’s purpose. ○ The study’s importance is clearly stated, with strong justification of the need for the study for audience(s).

INTRODUCTION SECTION (Continued)	
Research Purpose	The extent to which the purpose statement is clearly stated and its alignment with the research problem. Write a complete and clear purpose statement following the purpose statement script format. The script is below which you can copy and paste in your document and complete it by filling in the blanks. - The purpose of this _____ (narrative, phenomenological, grounded theory, ethnographic, case) study is (was? will be?) to _____ (understand? describe? develop? discover?) the _____ (central phenomenon of the study) for _____ (the participants) at _____ (the site). At this stage in the research, the _____ (central phenomenon) will be generally defined as _____ (a general definition of the central phenomenon). ○ Purpose statement is unclear, not following script or lacking alignment with the research problem. ○ Purpose statement is present but lacks script areas or a clear connection to the research problem. ○ Purpose statement is clear, follows script, and strongly aligns with the research problem.
Research Questions	The clarity and alignment of the central question (and sub-questions) with the research purpose and approach. Write a well formulated central Research Question which clearly and completely aligns to the research purpose. Research questions typically start with a word such as What or How (end with ‘?’). Research questions are open-ended, evolving, and nondirectional. Research questions restate the purpose of the study in specific ‘contextual’ terms. Verify that the question is encoded based on the research approach stated in the purpose statement. This is an example showing the difference between a quantitative and qualitative research question: Quantitative RQ. "What are the factors related to remote work stress?" Qualitative RQ. "How do employees in customer service roles at a medium-sized bank perceive the work dynamics and related stress while working remotely?" ○ Research questions are unclear, not well formulated or fail to align/congruent with the research purpose. ○ Research questions are partially defined or partially in alignment/congruent with the research purpose. ○ Research questions are clearly stated, well defined for qualitative research, and demonstrate strong alignment/congruent with the research purpose and context of the study.
Interpretive Framework and Assumptions	The extent to which the framework and researcher assumptions relevant to the research study are clearly stated. Describe the interpretive framework you are using (Postpositivist/Deductive, Social Constructivist/Inductive, Pragmatic). Describe your ontological assumptions (how you will construe reality?) Describe your epistemological assumptions (what will count as evidence of that reality?) Describe your axiological assumptions (what are your own researcher values relevant to the study?) Describe your methodological assumptions (select one of the five qualitative research approaches) Hint: Remember to use the Social Constructivist framework for your proposal with the associated assumptions. ○ Framework and Assumptions are not stated, or the connection to the research is unclear. ○ Some assumptions are stated but lack clarity or are incorrect or lack relevance to the proposed research. ○ Framework and Assumptions are clearly stated, are correct and demonstrate relevance to the proposal.
Terminology Definitions	The extent to which key terminology is defined for clarity and understanding. Note that you don’t need to provide a separate section for terminology definitions if you already provided the definitions as part of the Purpose sub-section. ○ No key terms are defined, leading to potential confusion. ○ Some key terms are defined, but important terms may be missing or unclear. ○ Key terminology is clearly defined, enhancing clarity, and understanding.

LITERATURE REVIEW SECTION

This section of the proposal provides your critical integration of literature and provides the context of your study. The literature review should:

- Provide a synthesis of relevant literature and theoretical foundations for the study (if any theory is discussed)
- Use the literature to demonstrate gaps in knowledge and show how your study will contribute
- Cite a minimum of eight sources (from peer reviewed journals), positioning your research in relevant fields

Use the rubric guidance below to guide and iterate your literature review.

The extent to which the literature reviewed is relevant to the research topic and research questions.

- Literature reviewed is largely irrelevant to the research topic or fails to address the research questions.
- Some relevant literature is included, but there are significant gaps or inconsistencies in coverage.
- Literature reviewed is highly relevant to the research topic and effectively addresses the research questions.

The extent to which the literature is critically evaluated, including strengths, weaknesses, and gaps in existing research.

- Literature review lacks critical analysis, with no evaluation of strengths, weaknesses, or gaps in existing research.
- Some critical analysis is present, but it is limited in scope or depth, and may not effectively identify key gaps in the literature.
- Literature review demonstrates thorough critical analysis, evaluating strengths, weaknesses, and gaps in existing research in a clear and comprehensive manner.

Synthesize and integrate findings from different sources to develop a coherent and well-supported argument.

- Literature review fails to synthesize findings from different sources, presenting disjointed or contradictory information.
- Some synthesis of findings is evident, but it lacks coherence or integration, and may not effectively support the arguments.
- Literature review effectively synthesizes findings from different sources, presenting coherent and well-supported arguments.

METHODOLOGY SECTION

We will cover these topics during Weeks 4 through 7 to support your learning and the iterative development of your proposal.

This section describes how and in what ways you plan to conduct the study.

The methodology section has the following sub-sections:

- Qualitative Approach
- Data Collection
- Data Analysis
- Ethical Considerations

The description of each sub-section and rubric guidance are provided below. Use the rubric guidance to apply learning and iterate.

Qualitative Approach	The extent to which the chosen qualitative inquiry approach (e.g., case study, grounded theory, phenomenology, ethnography, narrative) is described, justified, and aligns with the research purpose and questions. ○ Qualitative approach is unclear, inappropriate, or not identified. ○ The approach is identified but lacks clear justification or connection to the research purpose and questions. ○ The approach is clearly identified, well-justified, and demonstrates strong alignment with the research questions and purpose.
Data Collection	The extent to which all the data collection activities are explained. This sub-section includes how you plan to: locating site/individual, gaining access, and developing rapport, sampling purposefully, collecting data, recording information, minimizing fieldwork issues, storing data securely. ○ Data collection is unclear or not described in detail, with limited use of the data collection concepts ○ Data collection activities are described but lacks sufficient detail, justification, or alignment with the research ○ Data collection is clear and comprehensive, with strong justification and alignment with the research
Data Analysis	The extent to which the data analysis strategies are described and justified. This sub-section includes how you plan to: managing and organizing data, reading and memoing emergent ideas, describing and classifying codes into themes, developing, and assessing interpretations, and representing and visualizing the data. ○ Data analysis strategies are unclear or not described in detail, with limited use of data analysis concepts ○ Data analysis strategies are described but lack sufficient detail, justification, or alignment with the research ○ Data analysis strategies are clearly and completely described, well-justified, and strongly aligned with the research approach and questions.
Ethical Considerations	The extent to which ethical concerns are addressed regarding data collection and data analysis, including confidentiality, informed consent, and validation strategies. ○ Ethical concerns are not addressed, or the discussion is general or not relevant to the study ○ Some ethical concerns are addressed, but it lacks comprehensiveness or clarity ○ Ethical considerations are addressed with a clear connection to the research anticipating and describing how to address key situations

EXPECTED CONTRIBUTION Discuss the expected value of the research in relation to the problem presented in the introduction.
The extent to which the proposal explains the anticipated potential contributions to practice and academia. ○ Contribution to research is not addressed or is unclear. ○ Potential contribution is mentioned but lacks depth or specificity. ○ The proposal clearly outlines how the research will contribute to address the problem described in the introduction.
PROPOSED TIMELINE Provide a high-level schedule timeline for key research activities.
The extent to which the timeline outlines the qualitative research process activities. ○ Timeline is missing, unclear, or does not effectively outline the qualitative research methodology. ○ Timeline is included but is somewhat unclear or lacks key elements of the qualitative research methodology. ○ Timeline is clear, comprehensive, and outlines all key elements of the qualitative research methodology.
REFERENCES List complete AP citation style references for all works cited in your proposal.
OVERAL PAPER FORMATTING Follow APA formatting. Proofread and edit your writing.